



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

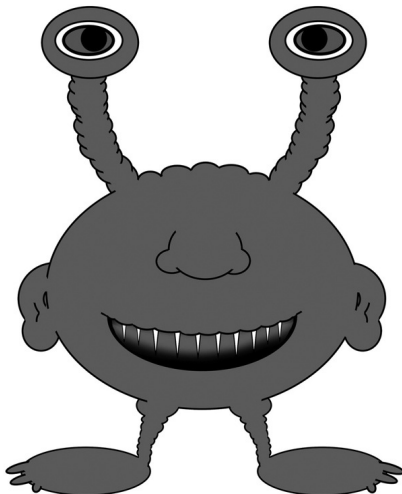
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Let's Start!

Was there ever life on Mars?



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about science and exploration.
- I can talk about imaginary situations.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the planet Mars?
- Would you be interested in going on a manned mission to Mars?

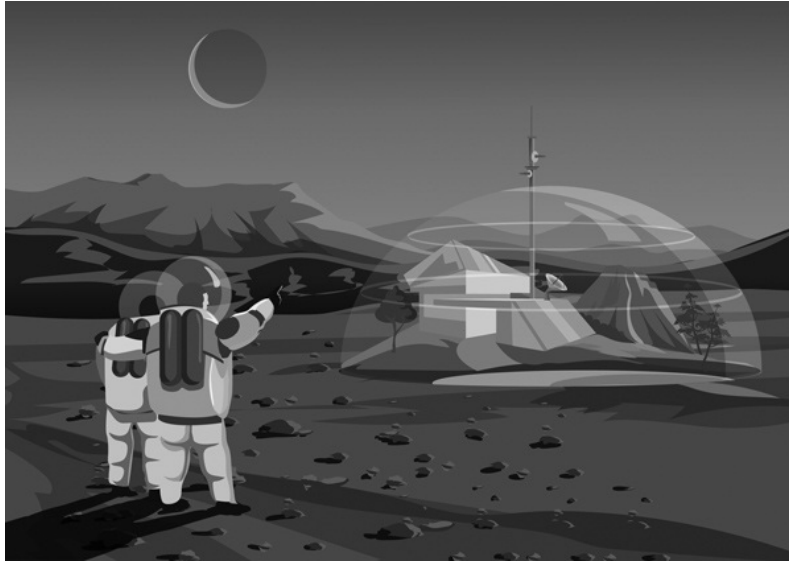




Let's Explore!

Look up at the **red planet***!

* Mars is called the "*red planet*" because it looks orange-red in the sky.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

If I knew space travel was safe, I'd be on the next ship out. Would it be too late for me to travel through the galaxy if it were to happen soon? For me probably, not for many others, if the technology were to become available, they, like me, would be thinking of going too. Have you ever observed someone gazing into the night sky with longing? Have you overheard people speaking of astronauts with envy? Have you caught scientists talking about looking for proof of life on other planets?

How many times have you watched people hanging on every word of science fiction movies? Have you ever noticed comets hurtling through the night sky and wondered what it would look like up close? Has it ever left you wondering who or what else is out there? Until recently, however, no one had discovered hard evidence that living things ever existed on another planet. A meteorite found on a scientific expedition to Antarctica in 1984 suggested that there might once have been life on another planet. A NASA scientific team studied the 4.25-pound meteorite for twelve years.

They estimated the rock's age at 4.5 billion years. Could it have been from Mars? If scientists knew for sure, they wouldn't have to keep looking for answers. Today they are still looking to the red planet for signs of life. What would they do if they found it? Would they put together a manned mission if they had some answers? If you were still following such inquiries, they might be answered sometime after 2024 when the first Mars Mission leaves Earth.





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about imaginary situations.

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Match the two halves to correctly complete each sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. If I knew space travel was safe, | a. wouldn't have to keep looking for answers. |
| 2. Would it be too late for me to travel through | b. the galaxy if it were to happen soon. |
| 3. For me probably, not for many others. If the technology were to become | c. we would be able to find answers in an easiest way. |
| 4. If scientists knew for sure, they | d. available, they, like me, would be thinking of going too. |
| 5. If the technology were to become available, | e. I'd be on the next ship out. |



Let's Practice!

Someone has a lot of questions.

Instructions: Select the correct answer. Complete the sentences.

Use: overheard people speaking / watched people hanging / observed someone gazing / left you wondering / caught scientists talking

- Have you ever _____ into the night sky with longing?
- Have you _____ of astronauts with envy?
- Have you _____ about looking for proof of life on other planets?
- How many times have you _____ on every word of a science fiction movie?
- Has it ever _____ who or what else is out there?





Extension Activity

Watch the film, *The Martian*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the film *The Martian* to find out about a mission to Mars.
- Take notes on what people will have to overcome to be able to exist on the red planet.
- With a group, discuss what you have noted, saying whether you believe these things are or are not possible to overcome.
- Discuss how you feel about manned missions to Mars in general and whether you think anyone could survive one and continue to live on Mars.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch the film *The Martian*.

☐ ☐

I take notes on what people will have to overcome to be able to exist on the red planet.

☐ ☐

I discuss the hardships of a manned mission to Mars with a partner or group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to gaze** (verb): to look at something for a long time
e.g. Have you ever observed someone gazing into the night sky with longing?
- **to overhear** (verb): to hear what people are saying without intending to, and without their knowledge
e.g. Have you overheard people speaking of astronauts with envy?
- **comet** (noun): a body of rock and ice that travels around the sun
e.g. Have you ever noticed comets hurtling through the night sky and wondered what it would look like up close?
- **to hurtle** (verb): to move very fast
e.g. Have you ever noticed comets hurtling through the night sky and wondered what it would look like up close?
- **hard evidence** (noun): physical, measurable proof
e.g. Until recently, however, no one had discovered hard evidence that living things ever existed on another planet.
- **meteorite** (noun): rock from space that has landed on Earth
e.g. A meteorite found on a scientific expedition to Antarctica in 1984 suggested that there might once have been life on another planet.
- **red planet** (noun): another name for Mars
e.g. Today they are still looking to the red planet for signs of life.
- **manned mission** (noun): a human crew of explorers
e.g. Would they put together a manned mission if they had some answers.





Learning Points

Unreal Conditional: Expressing Imaginary Future Situations

You use the Unreal Conditional to express imaginary or future situations.

The Unreal Conditional is also called the second conditional.

You use the structure:

If... Simple Past, ... would+verb or

Would + verb ... if ... Simple Past.

Example:

If scientists knew for sure they wouldn't have to keep looking for answers.

Scientists can't know for sure, so they probably have to keep looking for answers.

You use *If ... were + to + infinitive* to talk about imaginary future situations, especially when it is not likely the situation will happen.

Example:

If you were to stand in a crowded area and watch the people, what would you see?

Examples:

- *If I knew space travel was safe, I'd be on the next ship out.*
- *Would it be too late for me to travel through the galaxy if it were to happen soon?*
- *For me it's probably too late, but for many others, if the technology were to become available, they ,like me, would be thinking of going too.*
- *If scientists knew for sure they wouldn't have to keep looking for answers.*





Learning Points

Verbs Followed by -ing with Objects

When you talk about two actions linked together, you normally use two verbs. The first verb follows the rules of conjugation for the sentence, while the second verb can be a verb in the -ing form.

You can use two verbs to talk about two connected actions. The main verb introduces the main action, and the second verb in the -ing form gives more information about that action.

You can use a variety of verbs followed by a verb in the -ing form. Some of these verbs are related in meaning, or have opposite meanings, like:

like/dislike, start/stop, can't bear/stand, love/adore/hate, allow/forbid, admit/deny, quit/finish, appreciate/resent ...

You can often put an object between the two verbs. You can use pronouns and possessives.

Structure:

Subject + first verb + object + -ing form of the second verb

Example:

Have you ever observed someone gazing into the night sky with longing?

Look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Have you overheard people speaking of astronauts with envy?*
- *Have you caught scientists talking about looking for proof of life on other planets?*
- *How many times have you watched people hanging on every word of science fiction movie?*
- *Has it ever left you wondering who or what else is out there?*
- *Have you ever noticed comets hurtling through the night sky and wondered what it would look like up close?*

